

GuruNanda, v. Sacks Holdings, Inc.

Design-patent comparison of an ornamental bottle-cap form and raised lattice pattern against Grin Oral Care rinse packaging.

Independent preliminary research based on public information.

FILED	FORUM	DOCKET	MATTER
2026-08-20	S.D. Cal.	3:26-cv-04764	Patent Infringement

Prepared 2026-08-25. No attorney or expert contacted. Availability, interest, compensation, and conflicts not checked.

Public filing, likely recipient, and technical frame

CAPTION	GuruNanda, LLC v. Sacks Holdings, Inc.
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FORUM / DOCKET	S.D. Cal. / 3:26-cv-04764
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FILED / TYPE	2026-08-20 / patent infringement
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PUBLIC DOCKET	Open docket
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VERIFIED PUBLIC RECORD

GuruNanda, LLC v. Sacks Holdings, Inc., No. 3:26-cv-04764, filed 2026-08-20 in S.D. Cal..

LIKELY RESEARCH PURCHASER

Christopher D. Bright - Snell & Wilmer L.L.P.; named matter counsel. The public docket identifies Bright as plaintiff counsel and complaint filer. Selecting the complaint filer as likely purchaser is an analytical inference from that role.

cbright@swlaw.com - publicly listed on the [official firm biography](#); not inferred.

TECHNICAL FRAME

Design-patent comparison of an ornamental bottle-cap form and raised lattice pattern against Grin Oral Care rinse packaging.

Secondary-source limitation: This is a preliminary technical frame based on public sources. Filed pleadings, claim charts, discovery, source code, product versions, and admissible evidence must control. [Open public synopsis](#)

Questions likely to require expert input

This issue map is a research plan, not a legal conclusion. The filed complaint, patent exhibits, intrinsic record, and discovery must control.

01 What overall visual impression is created by the claimed cap silhouette, proportions, transitions, and raised lattice pattern?

What overall visual impression is created by the claimed cap silhouette, proportions, transitions, and raised lattice pattern?

Potential evidence: Pleadings and claim charts; source code or engineering records; product and version documentation; standards and prior art; reproducible testing; and fact or technical testimony as applicable.

02 Which similarities are ornamental rather than dictated by bottle closure, grip, molding, sealing, or labeling functions?

Which similarities are ornamental rather than dictated by bottle closure, grip, molding, sealing, or labeling functions?

Potential evidence: Pleadings and claim charts; source code or engineering records; product and version documentation; standards and prior art; reproducible testing; and fact or technical testimony as applicable.

03 How crowded is the prior-art field, and what differences would an ordinary observer familiar with that field notice?

How crowded is the prior-art field, and what differences would an ordinary observer familiar with that field notice?

Potential evidence: Pleadings and claim charts; source code or engineering records; product and version documentation; standards and prior art; reproducible testing; and fact or technical testimony as applicable.

Questions likely to require expert input

Candidates 1-2 for further diligence

Ranked for preliminary research priority based on subject-matter fit, relevant public work, testimony, and visible diligence burden. This is not a retention recommendation.

01 Joel Delman

Industrial-design expert witness and founder, Informed Innovation

TECHNICAL FIT

Exceptional fit for ordinary-observer design comparison, design-patent validity/infringement, product form, and functionality.

RELEVANT WORK

More than 30 years in industrial design, 45+ design/utility patents, and chair of IDSA's Design Protection Committee.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

Public profile reports 22 depositions/testimony matters in the prior four years and design-patent work.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Commercial expert-witness practice and extensive testimony demand conflict and prior-position review.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | joel@informedinnovationinc.com | [public email source](#)

02 Paul Hatch

CEO, Hatch IP LLC; industrial-design expert witness

TECHNICAL FIT

Exceptional fit for design-patent comparison, prior-art form analysis, consumer products, CAD, and manufacturing.

RELEVANT WORK

30+ years in industrial design, 50+ patents, and leadership of TEAMS Design USA.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

Public site reports 25+ IP cases, 20+ depositions, and seven court appearances.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Gmail address is publicly printed by his business but is not institutional; substantial prior testimony requires position/conflict diligence.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | hatch.ip.llc@gmail.com | [public email source](#)

Candidates 3-4 for further diligence

03 Lance Rake

Professor of Industrial Design, University of Kansas

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for consumer-product and packaging form, design process, and design-patent comparison.

RELEVANT WORK

More than 40 years practicing and teaching industrial design; designed consumer products and packaging.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

Public university profile states he has served as an expert witness in design-patent infringement and product-liability matters.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Broad product work rather than oral-care packaging; prior opinions need review.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | lgrake@ku.edu | [public email source](#)

04 Cliff Shin

Professor and Chair of Industrial Design, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

TECHNICAL FIT

Fit for visual complexity, familiarity, aesthetic longevity, and overall product-form impressions.

RELEVANT WORK

Research specifically examines visual complexity, visual entropy, familiarity, and aesthetic longevity.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Academic perceptual focus; no public litigation experience or bottle-cap specialization located.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | theciff@illinois.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 5-6 for further diligence

05 Jim Budd

Chair and Professor, Georgia Tech School of Industrial Design

TECHNICAL FIT

Fit for consumer/business product design, human-centered form, interactive products, and development process.

RELEVANT WORK

More than 20 years of industry design experience before academia; leads interactive product-design research.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Interaction focus may be less relevant to purely ornamental cap/lattice comparison.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | jim.budd@design.gatech.edu | [public email source](#)

06 Yvette Chaparro

Associate Professor of Product and Industrial Design, Parsons School of Design

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for consumer-product form, product families, typology, modularity, and brand design.

RELEVANT WORK

Industry design leadership for Calvin Klein, Tommy Hilfiger, West Elm, Kate Spade, and housewares brands.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Brand relationships and limited public litigation record require diligence.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | chaparro@newschool.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 7-8 for further diligence

07 Rebecca Pailes-Friedman

Professor of Industrial Design, Pratt Institute

TECHNICAL FIT

Fit for consumer-product design methodology, materials, user interaction, and visual/functional form.

RELEVANT WORK

More than 25 years teaching industrial design plus leadership roles at Fila, Champion, and Nike.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Soft-goods/wearables emphasis is not specific to rigid oral-care packaging.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | rpailles@pratt.edu | [public email source](#)

08 SK O'Brien

Assistant Professor of Product Design, University of Kentucky

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for housewares/product form, materials/process, and patented consumer design.

RELEVANT WORK

Former Kohler lead designer; holds ten patents and Red Dot, iF, and IDEA awards.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Early academic rank and no public litigation testimony located.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | obrien.design@uky.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 9-10 for further diligence

09 Michael Barry

Adjunct Professor of Mechanical Engineering and product designer, Stanford d.school

TECHNICAL FIT

Fit for consumer packaged goods, product design, engineering integration, and needfinding.

RELEVANT WORK

Three decades of strategic product design, dozens of patents, and clients including Kimberly-Clark, Nestlé, and Unilever.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Consulting relationships create conflict complexity; no public design-patent testimony located.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | mrbarry@stanford.edu | [public email source](#)

10 Tong Jin (TJ) Kim

Professor of Industrial Design, Purdue University

TECHNICAL FIT

Fit for product-form development, design strategy, manufacturability, and patented visual/functional design.

RELEVANT WORK

18 years in industry, 300+ designed products, 70+ U.S. patents, and 30+ design awards.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Broad product portfolio; direct bottle-closure or oral-care work is not shown.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | kim1886@purdue.edu | [public email source](#)

Preliminary candidates; no conflicts or availability determination

- Run party, affiliate, counsel, inventor, funder, and technology conflicts.
- Confirm testimony history, exclusions, compensation, publications, patents, and deposition performance.
- Investigate licensing, grants, consulting, commercial interests, and prior technical positions.
- Confirm role fit, availability, and interest only after counsel authorizes outreach.

ONGOING MATTER-SPECIFIC RESEARCH

Flint Witness Research works in the post-filing window, turning pleadings and public technical records into issue maps, researched candidate slates, and diligence starting points as the case develops.

[Schedule a 15-minute conversation](#)

CORE SOURCES

Public docket: <https://dockets.justia.com/docket/california/casdc/3%3A2026cv04764/867773>

Official attorney biography and email: https://ptacts.uspto.gov/ptacts/public-informations/petitions/1557458/download-documents?artifactId=j_89em9GNepTzfTzJmh7PYVkj-9buDBc4tZr1WRcEuvB8Ef9pLobNO0

Public technical context source: <https://ai-lab.exparte.com/case/dct/casdc/3%3A26-cv-04764/doc/analysis/1>

LIMITATIONS

This is a preliminary technical frame based on public sources. Filed pleadings, claim charts, discovery, source code, product versions, and admissible evidence must control.

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